Chapter 10 — Spring Security 1: Fundamentals

Every request raises two questions: **who is calling?** and **may they do this?** Spring Security answers both with a chain of servlet filters (code the web server runs on every request before Spring MVC) that runs *before* your controllers, and switches on protections you would otherwise forget — CSRF tokens (§10.8), security headers (§10.11), session-fixation defence (§10.10) — the moment you add the starter. It is not magic: once you can picture the filter chain, name the object holding the current user, and tell a 401 ("I don't know who you are") from a 403 ("I know you, but no"), the rest is configuration.

All code lives in `code/` — three Spring Boot **4.1.1** projects (Spring Security **7.1.1**, Framework 7, Java 25). Output blocks are real `mvn -q -B -ntp verify` output (Spring log lines trimmed to `...`; hashes and timings change per run).

Project	Shows
`security-defaults`	the starter with zero configuration
`security-basics`	filter chain, authentication, passwords, authorization, method security
`security-web-defenses`	two chains (API + browser app), CSRF on/off, CORS preflight, headers, sessions

Prerequisites. Proxies (Chapter 4) explain method security; controllers come from Spring MVC (Chapter 5). The *browser* side of CORS, CSRF and XSS (cross-site scripting: an attacker's JavaScript running on your pages) is in the JavaScript handbook, Chapter 14. Tokens, JWT (JSON Web Token: a signed token carrying user details) and OAuth2 (the standard protocol for issuing access tokens) continue in Chapter 11.

10.1 Vocabulary and what the starter does by default

What it is

Spring Security is the Spring project for authentication, authorization and protection against common web attacks; Boot 4 adds it with `spring-boot-starter-security`.

Term	Plain meaning
Principal	the "who" — a user, a service, a device
Credentials	the proof — password, token, certificate
Authentication	checking the proof and deciding who the caller is
Authorization	deciding whether that caller may do *this* action
Authority (`GrantedAuthority`)	one permission string the caller holds, e.g. `report:read`
Role	an authority whose name starts with `ROLE_`, e.g. `ROLE_ADMIN`; a coarse group of permissions
Security context	the per-request holder of the current `Authentication`

Authentication produces an `Authentication` object (principal + authorities + "is authenticated" flag). **Authorization reads it.**

What happens with zero configuration

Add the starter, write one controller, and run the test in `security-defaults`:

```java
@Test
void everythingIsLockedByDefault(CapturedOutput startupLog) throws Exception {
    // 1. Boot generated a user called "user" and logged its random password at startup
    String line = startupLog.getAll().lines()
            .filter(l -> l.contains("Using generated security password")).findFirst().orElseThrow();
    String password = line.substring(line.indexOf(':') + 1).trim();
    // 2. browser-style request -> redirect to the generated login page
    MvcTestResult browser = mvc.get().uri("/hello").header(HttpHeaders.ACCEPT, "text/html").exchange();
    assertThat(browser).hasStatus(302).hasRedirectedUrl("/login");
    // 3. API-style request -> 401 plus a Basic challenge
    MvcTestResult api = mvc.get().uri("/hello").header(HttpHeaders.ACCEPT, "application/json").exchange();
    assertThat(api).hasStatus(401);
    // 4. with the generated credentials it works
    MvcTestResult ok = mvc.get().uri("/hello").with(httpBasic("user", password)).exchange();
    assertThat(ok).hasStatusOk().hasBodyTextEqualTo("hello");
}
```

Output:

```
Using generated security password: 4030de5f-fb5d-4c46-bd81-7a0af09efd28

This generated password is for development use only. Your security configuration must be updated before running
your application in production.
...
startup log   : Using generated security password: <36-char UUID>
browser, anon : 302 -> /login
api, anon     : 401 WWW-Authenticate=Basic realm="Realm", charset="UTF-8"
basic, user   : 200 body=hello
```

With no code at all, Boot and Spring Security:

1. Protect **every** URL.
2. Create one in-memory user `user` with a random UUID (128-bit identifier) password logged at startup (nothing stored). `spring.security.user.name/password/roles` fix it — for experiments only.
3. Enable **form login** (a generated `/login` page) and **HTTP Basic** (username and password sent in a header on every request).
4. Pick the response by client type: a browser asking for HTML (`Accept: text/html`, e.g. Chrome) gets a `302` redirect to `/login`; a JSON client (e.g. Postman, curl) gets `401` with `WWW-Authenticate: Basic`. The `charset="UTF-8"` parameter is new in Spring Security 7.1.
5. Turn on CSRF protection, security headers, session-fixation protection and a logout endpoint.

Declaring your own `SecurityFilterChain` bean makes Boot's default chain back off; declaring a `UserDetailsService`, `AuthenticationManager` or `AuthenticationProvider` (or an OAuth2 setup — Chapter 11) removes the generated user.

Secure by default means forgetting something fails *closed*: a new endpoint is protected, not exposed. The price is the "why does my new app return 401?" moment — because you have not told Spring who may call it yet.

TL;DR

- Authentication = *who are you*, authorization = *may you*; the `Authentication` object links them.
- The starter alone locks every URL, generates a dev-only user and enables form login, Basic, CSRF and headers.

10.2 Architecture: the filter chain

What it is

Spring Security is a **servlet filter** — code that sees every HTTP request before the `DispatcherServlet` does — made of an ordered **list of small filters**, each with one job. If any filter says no, the request

never reaches your controller.

How it works



1. **`DelegatingFilterProxy`** is a plain servlet filter Boot registers with the container. The container creates filters itself and cannot see Spring beans, so this filter only looks up a Spring bean and delegates to it.
2. That bean is **`FilterChainProxy`** (`springSecurityFilterChain`). It holds one or more **`SecurityFilterChain`**`s` and, per request, runs only the **first** chain whose request matcher fits (chains are never combined; order by `@Order`).
3. Each chain is an ordered list of **security filters**. The important ones:

Filter	Job
`SecurityContextHolderFilter`	loads the `SecurityContext` (e.g. from the HTTP session) into `SecurityContextHolder` for this request, and clears it afterwards
`HeaderWriterFilter`	adds security headers (§10.11)
`CorsFilter`	answers CORS preflights (§10.9), only if `cors()` is configured
`CsrfFilter`	rejects state-changing requests without a valid CSRF token (§10.8)
`LogoutFilter`	handles `POST /logout`
`UsernamePasswordAuthenticationFilter`	processes the login form `POST /login`
`BasicAuthenticationFilter`	reads `Authorization: Basic ...`
`BearerTokenAuthenticationFilter`	reads `Authorization: Bearer ...` (Chapter 11)
`AnonymousAuthenticationFilter`	if nobody authenticated, puts an *anonymous* `Authentication` in the context
`ExceptionTranslationFilter`	turns security exceptions from later filters into HTTP responses: 401/redirect or 403
`AuthorizationFilter`	the last gate: asks the `AuthorizationManager` whether this request is allowed

4. **`SecurityContextHolder`** stores the current `SecurityContext` in a `ThreadLocal` (a separate value per thread; each request runs on its own thread) by default. Any code on the request thread can read it with `SecurityContextHolder.getContext().getAuthentication()`.

The test in `security-basics` prints the real filter list of our chain:

```
@Autowired FilterChainProxy springSecurityFilterChain;

@Test
void printTheFilters() {
    List<SecurityFilterChain> chains = springSecurityFilterChain.getFilterChains();
    List<String> names = chains.getFirst().getFilters().stream().map(f -> f.getClass().getSimpleName()).toList();
    // ... print with numbers
    assertThat(names.getLast()).isEqualTo("AuthorizationFilter");
}
```

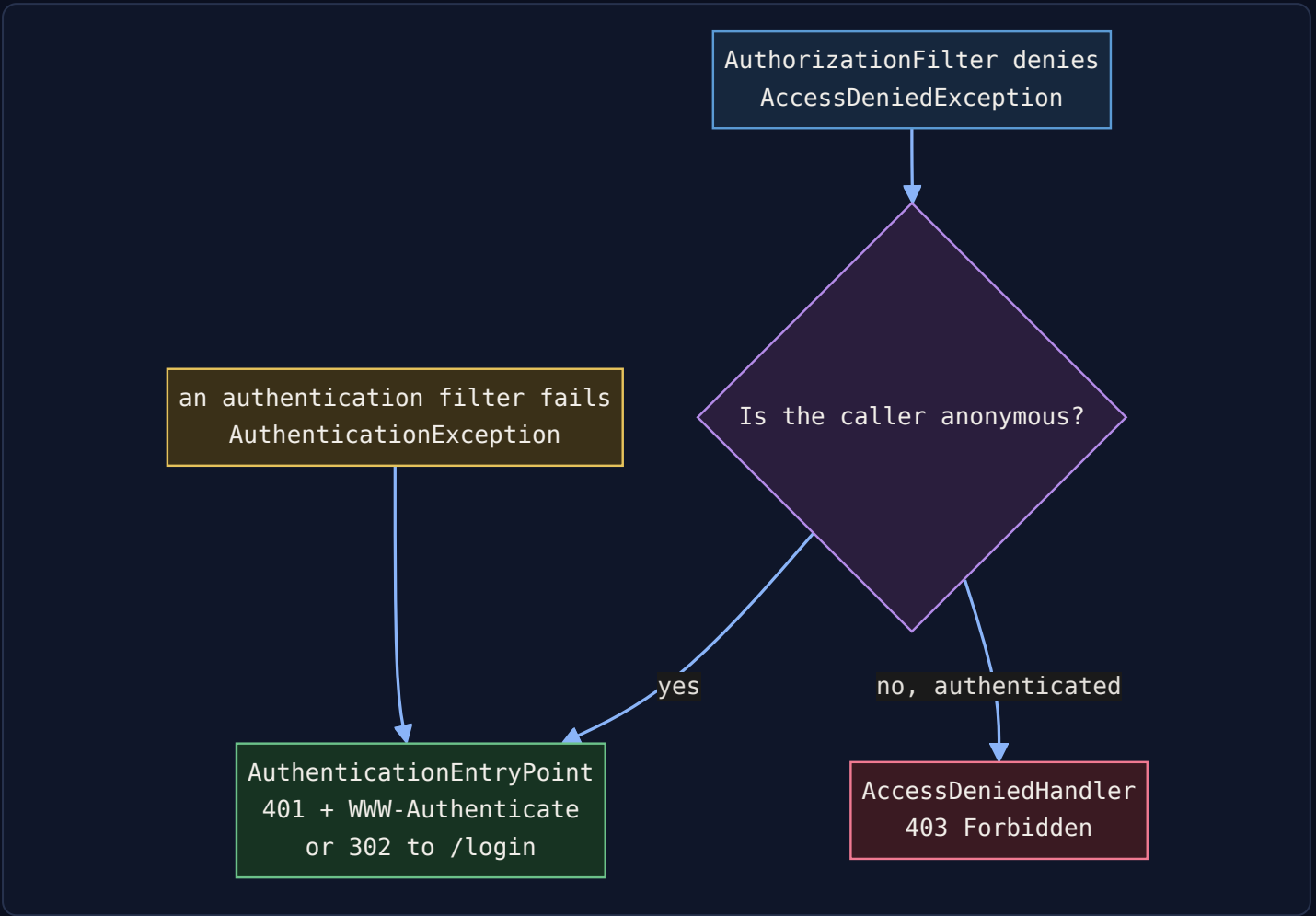
Output:

```
security filter chains: 1
 1 DisableEncodeUrlFilter
 2 WebAsyncManagerIntegrationFilter
 3 SecurityContextHolderFilter
 4 HeaderWriterFilter
 5 CsrfFilter
 6 LogoutFilter
 7 UsernamePasswordAuthenticationFilter
 8 DefaultResourcesFilter
 9 DefaultLoginPageGeneratingFilter
10 DefaultLogoutPageGeneratingFilter
11 BasicAuthenticationFilter
12 RequestCacheAwareFilter
13 SecurityContextHolderAwareRequestFilter
14 AnonymousAuthenticationFilter
15 ExceptionTranslationFilter
16 AuthorizationFilter
```

The list changes with configuration: removing `formLogin()` removes `UsernamePasswordAuthenticationFilter` and the login page; `oauth2ResourceServer()` adds `BearerTokenAuthenticationFilter`. Printing it, or `logging.level.org.springframework.security=TRACE`, is the fastest way to see what a chain really does.

How a denied request becomes 401 or 403

`ExceptionTranslationFilter` sits just before `AuthorizationFilter` and catches what it throws:



- An **`AuthenticationEntryPoint`** "starts authentication". It is `401` with a challenge header for APIs, or a redirect to a login page for browsers. Before redirecting, the original request is saved in the **request cache**, so after login the user lands where they wanted to go.
- An **`AccessDeniedHandler`** answers `403` for callers who *are* known but lack permission.

Why it matters

- **Debugging.** "403 before my controller runs" is a filter problem, not an MVC problem; the filter list tells you which one.
- **Ordering.** Place custom filters with `http.addFilterBefore(myFilter, BasicAuthenticationFilter.class)` and friends, never a guessed order number.
- **Threads.** The `ThreadLocal` context does *not* follow work handed to another thread (`@Async`, executors, `CompletableFuture`, scheduled jobs); use `DelegatingSecurityContextExecutor` (or the `DelegatingSecurityContext*` wrappers).

Common mistakes

- Registering your security filter as a plain `@Component` `Filter`: Boot *also* adds it to the servlet container, so it runs twice, once outside the chain. Add it via `http.addFilter...` and disable the servlet registration with a `FilterRegistrationBean` whose `setEnabled(false)`.

TL;DR

Container → `DelegatingFilterProxy` → `FilterChainProxy` → first matching `SecurityFilterChain` → ordered filters → `AuthorizationFilter` last; `ExceptionTranslationFilter` turns denials into 401/redirect (anonymous) or 403 (known). The current user lives in `SecurityContextHolder` (a `ThreadLocal`).

10.3 Configuring a chain: the lambda DSL in Spring Security 7

What it is

Declare a `SecurityFilterChain` bean and build it with the `HttpSecurity` **DSL** (domain-specific language: a fluent builder where each method configures one feature via a `Customizer` lambda). The whole configuration of `security-basics`:

```
@Configuration
@EnableMethodSecurity // turns on @PreAuthorize / @PostAuthorize / @PreFilter / @PostFilter
class SecurityConfig {

    @Bean
    SecurityFilterChain appSecurity(HttpSecurity http) throws Exception {
        http
            .authorizeHttpRequests(auth -> auth                     // first match wins, top to bottom
                .requestMatchers("/public/**").permitAll()
                .requestMatchers("/admin/**").hasRole("ADMIN")        // checks authority "ROLE_ADMIN"
                .requestMatchers("/user/**").hasRole("USER")          // ADMIN also passes (hierarchy below)
                .requestMatchers(HttpMethod.GET, "/reports/**").hasAuthority("report:read")
                .requestMatchers("/me", "/orders/**").authenticated()
                .anyRequest().denyAll())                              // anything we forgot is closed
            .httpBasic(Customizer.withDefaults())                     // Authorization: Basic ... for APIs
            .formLogin(Customizer.withDefaults());                    // /login page for browsers
        return http.build();
    }

    @Bean
    PasswordEncoder passwordEncoder() {
        return PasswordEncoderFactories.createDelegatingPasswordEncoder();
    }

    @Bean
    static RoleHierarchy roleHierarchy() {
        return RoleHierarchyImpl.fromHierarchy("ROLE_ADMIN > ROLE_USER");
    }
}
```

- `Customizer.withDefaults()` is a no-op lambda: "turn this feature on with default settings". `feature(f -> f.disable())` turns one off.
- With Boot, `@EnableWebSecurity` is applied for you (harmless to add).

What changed in Spring Security 7

Spring Security 7 finished clean-ups that 6.x had deprecated; old tutorials use the removed style:

Removed in 7	Use instead
`.and()` chaining (`http.csrf().disable().and().httpBasic()`)	one lambda per feature (above)
`authorizeRequests(...)`	`authorizeHttpRequests(...)` (built on `AuthorizationManager`)
`AntPathRequestMatcher`, `MvcRequestMatcher`	`PathPatternRequestMatcher` — the same `PathPattern` syntax Spring MVC uses. `requestMatchers("/x/**")` creates them for you
`WebSecurityConfigurerAdapter` (already gone in 6.0)	`SecurityFilterChain` beans
`AccessDecisionManager` / voters in the main jar	moved to the legacy `spring-security-access` module; prefer `AuthorizationManager`
OAuth2 *password* grant support	authorization code or client credentials (Chapter 11)

Other 7.0 additions: built-in **multi-factor authentication** (MFA: two or more kinds of proof; §10.4), `csrf(c -> c.spa())` for single-page apps (SPAs; §10.8), Password4j-based encoders (§10.5), and Spring Authorization Server (issues OAuth2 tokens) now shipping *inside* Spring Security (Chapter 11).

Several chains in one application

Apps serving a JSON API *and* browser pages need different rules: the API stateless (the server keeps no login state; every request carries credentials) without CSRF, the pages on a session cookie with CSRF on. Declare two chains, each with a **`securityMatcher`** and an **`@Order`**:

```
@Bean @Order(1)
SecurityFilterChain apiChain(HttpSecurity http) throws Exception {
    http.securityMatcher("/api/**")                      // this chain only handles /api/**
        .authorizeHttpRequests(auth -> auth.anyRequest().authenticated())
        .httpBasic(Customizer.withDefaults())
        .cors(Customizer.withDefaults())
        .csrf(csrf -> csrf.disable())                    // safe ONLY because nothing relies on cookies
        .sessionManagement(s -> s.sessionCreationPolicy(SessionCreationPolicy.STATELESS));
    return http.build();
}

@Bean @Order(2)
SecurityFilterChain webChain(HttpSecurity http) throws Exception {   // no securityMatcher = everything else
    http.authorizeHttpRequests(auth -> auth.requestMatchers("/login").permitAll().anyRequest().authenticated())
        .formLogin(Customizer.withDefaults())
        .logout(Customizer.withDefaults());
    return http.build();
}
```

`securityMatcher` selects which *requests* the whole chain handles; `requestMatchers` inside `authorizeHttpRequests` defines *rules* within the chain. Mixing them up is a classic bug.

Common mistakes

- A chain **without** `securityMatcher` placed *before* a specific one matches everything, so the later chain never runs. Catch-all chains go last (highest `@Order`).
- Copying `.and()` or `authorizeRequests()` code from old posts — it no longer compiles in Spring Security 7.
- Declaring the `SecurityFilterChain` bean outside a scanned `@Configuration`: Boot's default chain stays active and nothing you wrote applies.

TL;DR

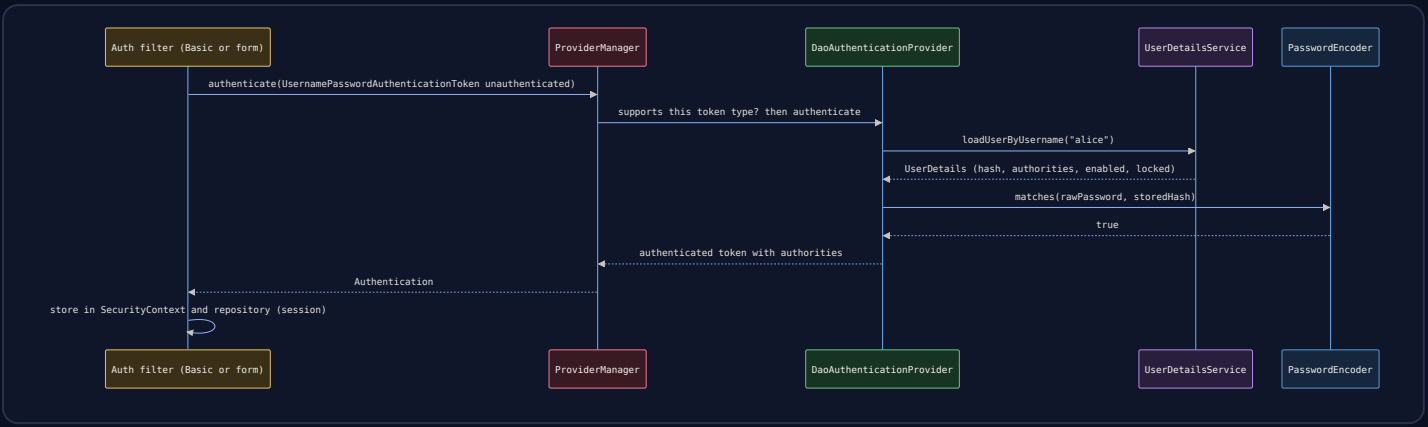
One `SecurityFilterChain` bean per chain, one lambda per feature. Spring Security 7 removed `and()`, `authorizeRequests` and the Ant/Mvc matchers. Several chains = `securityMatcher` + `@Order`, specific first.

10.4 Authentication: users, providers, form login and Basic

What it is

Authentication turns *credentials* into an `Authentication` saying who the caller is and what authorities they hold. Spring splits the work into small, replaceable interfaces.

How it works (username + password)



1. An **authentication filter** extracts credentials (`BasicAuthenticationFilter`: the `Authorization` header; `UsernamePasswordAuthenticationFilter`: the `POST /login` form) and builds an *unauthenticated* token.
2. It calls the **`AuthenticationManager`**; the standard **`ProviderManager`** asks each **`AuthenticationProvider`** whether it `supports` that token type.
3. **`DaoAuthenticationProvider`** loads the user through your **`UserDetailsService`**, checks account flags (enabled, not locked, not expired), and verifies the password with the **`PasswordEncoder`**.
4. On success the filter stores the token in the `SecurityContext`; form login also saves it in the HTTP session (recognised next time via the session cookie), while Basic resends credentials on *every* request.
5. On failure an `AuthenticationException` is thrown. Wrong password and unknown user both surface as `BadCredentialsException` (no username enumeration — discovering which accounts exist), and for an unknown user the provider still checks a dummy hash so timing does not leak it either.

`UserDetailsService`: your user store behind one method

`UserDetailsService` has one method, `loadUserByUsername(String)`, backed by a table, LDAP (a corporate directory protocol) or anything else. `security-basics` uses a map (a real app would use JPA — Chapter 8):

```java
@Service
public class AccountUserDetailsService implements UserDetailsService, UserDetailsPasswordService {

    public record Account(String username, String passwordHash, List<String> authorities, boolean enabled) {}
    private final Map<String, Account> accounts = new ConcurrentHashMap<>();

    AccountUserDetailsService(PasswordEncoder encoder) {
        save(new Account("alice", encoder.encode("alice-pass"), List.of("ROLE_USER", "report:read"), true));
        save(new Account("bob", encoder.encode("bob-pass"), List.of("ROLE_ADMIN"), true));
        save(new Account("carol", encoder.encode("carol-pass"), List.of("ROLE_USER"), true));
        save(new Account("dave", "{noop}dave-pass", List.of("ROLE_USER"), true));    // legacy plain-text row
        save(new Account("erin", encoder.encode("erin-pass"), List.of("ROLE_USER"), false)); // disabled
    }

    @Override
    public UserDetails loadUserByUsername(String username) {
        Account a = accounts.get(username);
        if (a == null) throw new UsernameNotFoundException(username);
        return User.withUsername(a.username()).password(a.passwordHash())
                .authorities(a.authorities().toArray(String[]::new))
                .disabled(!a.enabled()).build();
    }

    @Override   // see 10.5: called when a stored hash should be upgraded
    public UserDetails updatePassword(UserDetails user, String newEncodedPassword) { /* save new hash */ }
}
```

With this bean plus a `PasswordEncoder` bean, Spring builds the `DaoAuthenticationProvider` for you. Ready-made implementations: `InMemoryUserDetailsManager` (tests, demos), `JdbcUserDetailsManager` (Spring's `users` / `authorities` schema), LDAP.

Form login vs HTTP Basic

	Form login	HTTP Basic
Credentials sent	once, in `POST /login`	on **every** request, Base64 (a reversible text encoding) in `Authorization` (encoded, **not encrypted**, so HTTPS — HTTP over an encrypted TLS connection — only)
Remembered by	HTTP session cookie (`JSESSIONID`)	nothing, the client resends them
Unauthenticated response	`302` redirect to `/login`	`401` + `WWW-Authenticate: Basic realm=...`
Logout	`POST /logout` invalidates the session	impossible server-side (browser caches credentials)
Good for	server-rendered browser apps	scripts, service-to-service in trusted networks, quick demos

With both enabled, Spring picks the entry point per request: HTML-accepting browsers get the redirect, others (e.g. `Accept: application/json`) the `401` challenge:

```java
MvcTestResult noCreds  = mvc.get().uri("/me").header("Accept", "application/json").exchange();
MvcTestResult wrong    = mvc.get().uri("/me").with(httpBasic("alice", "nope")).exchange();
MvcTestResult disabled = mvc.get().uri("/me").with(httpBasic("erin", "erin-pass")).exchange();
MvcTestResult ok       = mvc.get().uri("/me").with(httpBasic("alice", "alice-pass")).exchange();
// formLogin() builds POST /login with username, password AND a valid CSRF token
mockMvc.perform(formLogin().user("alice").password("alice-
pass")).andExpect(authenticated().withUsername("alice"));
mockMvc.perform(formLogin().user("alice").password("wrong")).andExpect(unauthenticated());
```

Output:

```
no credentials (JSON)        401 WWW-Authenticate=Basic realm="Realm", charset="UTF-8"
alice, wrong password        401 WWW-Authenticate=Basic realm="Realm", charset="UTF-8"
erin, disabled account       401 WWW-Authenticate=Basic realm="Realm", charset="UTF-8"
alice, right password        200 {"name":"alice","principalType":"User","authorities":
["FACTOR_PASSWORD","ROLE_USER","report:read"]}
no credentials (HTML)        302 -> /login
form login, good password   302 -> /
form login, bad password    302 -> /login?error
```

Reading the current user

```
@GetMapping("/me")
Me me(Authentication auth, @AuthenticationPrincipal UserDetails principal) {
    return new Me(auth.getName(), principal.getClass().getSimpleName(),
            auth.getAuthorities().stream().map(GrantedAuthority::getAuthority).sorted().toList());
}
```

Spring MVC fills an `Authentication` (or `Principal`) parameter; `@AuthenticationPrincipal` gives the principal object itself (here our `UserDetails`). Elsewhere use `SecurityContextHolder.getContext().getAuthentication()`, but prefer passing the user in — `ThreadLocal` access is harder to test.

The `FACTOR_PASSWORD` authority: multi-factor authentication in Spring Security 7

Alice's authorities include `FACTOR_PASSWORD`. Spring Security 7 adds a **factor authority** (`FactorGrantedAuthority`) for every mechanism a user completes: `FACTOR_PASSWORD`, `FACTOR_OTT` (one-time token, e.g. an e-mailed code), `FACTOR_WEBAUTHN` (passkeys: password-less login with a key on the user's device). Rules can then demand several factors ("`/admin/**` needs `ROLE_ADMIN` **and** password **and** one-time token") via `@EnableMultiFactorAuthentication(authorities = ...)` or selectively `AuthorizationManagerFactories.multiFactor()`; a missing factor sends the user to that factor's login step. Don't be surprised by `FACTOR_*` entries, and filter them out when copying authorities into a token (Chapter 11 does).

Common mistakes

- Returning `null` from `loadUserByUsername` — the contract is to throw `UsernameNotFoundException`.
- Telling users "unknown username" vs "wrong password" — enables account enumeration.
- Logging or returning the `UserDetails` (with its hash). Map it to a DTO.
- HTTP Basic over plain HTTP — Base64 is readable by anyone on the path.

In the interview

> **30-second answer:** "An authentication filter extracts credentials and hands an unauthenticated token to the `AuthenticationManager`. `ProviderManager` delegates to a provider that supports the token — for passwords, `DaoAuthenticationProvider`, which loads the user via `UserDetailsService` and verifies the hash with the `PasswordEncoder`. The result goes into the `SecurityContext`, and form login persists it in the session."

- *Why is `UsernameNotFoundException` turned into `BadCredentialsException`?* → To prevent username enumeration; a dummy password check also equalises timing.
- *How would you add login by API key?* → A filter (or `AuthenticationConverter`) building an `ApiKeyAuthenticationToken`, an `AuthenticationProvider` validating it, registered with `addFilterBefore(..., BasicAuthenticationFilter.class)`.
- *Why can't you "log out" of HTTP Basic?* → No server-side session; the browser caches and resends the credentials.

TL;DR

Filter → `AuthenticationManager` (`ProviderManager`) → `AuthenticationProvider` (`DaoAuthenticationProvider`) → `UserDetailsService` + `PasswordEncoder` → `Authentication` in the `SecurityContext`. Browsers: form login +

session. Scripts: Basic (HTTPS only). Tokens: Chapter 11.

10.5 Password storage: hashing with `DelegatingPasswordEncoder`

What it is

Never store passwords, not even encrypted. Store a **password hash**: the output of a one-way function, cheap to check once but expensive to compute billions of times, so a leaked database must be cracked one guess at a time. Three properties make it suitable:

Idea	Meaning	Why
One-way	you can't compute the password from the hash	a leak does not reveal passwords directly
Salt	a random value stored with each hash and mixed in	equal passwords get different hashes, and precomputed "rainbow tables" are useless
Work factor (cost)	a tunable amount of CPU and/or memory per check	makes each guess slow. Raise it as hardware gets faster

Fast general-purpose hashes (SHA-256, MD5 — built for checksums) are exactly wrong for passwords. Use an **adaptive password hash**:

Algorithm	Spring encoder	Notes
bcrypt	`BCryptPasswordEncoder` (default strength 10)	CPU-hard, battle-tested. Uses only the first **72 bytes** of the password
Argon2id	`Argon2PasswordEncoder` (needs Bouncy Castle `bcprov-jdk18on`)	memory-hard (resists GPU/ASIC cracking hardware). Password Hashing Competition winner; first choice of OWASP (Open Worldwide Application Security Project)
scrypt	`SCryptPasswordEncoder` (Bouncy Castle)	memory-hard
PBKDF2	`Pbkdf2PasswordEncoder`	when FIPS-140 (US approved-cryptography standard) compliance is required

Spring Security 7.0 also added **Password4j-based** encoders (`Argon2Password4jPasswordEncoder`, `BcryptPassword4jPasswordEncoder`, `ScryptPassword4jPasswordEncoder`, `Pbkdf2Password4jPasswordEncoder`, `BalloonHashingPassword4jPasswordEncoder`).

How `DelegatingPasswordEncoder` works

Algorithms age (MD5 → bcrypt → Argon2). `DelegatingPasswordEncoder` lets one database hold several generations; each stored value carries its algorithm id as a prefix:

```
{bcrypt}$2a$10$oExJt1cCgjfvb4DzBrmNo.VLE45g8zG8GLlEik43AL6a3Xbk8q20a
{argon2@SpringSecurity_v5_8}$argon2id$v=19$m=16384,t=2,p=1$...
{noop}dave-pass                          <- legacy plain text (never do this for real)
```

1. **`encode(raw)`** always uses the *current default* id. `PasswordEncoderFactories.createDelegatingPasswordEncoder()` uses `bcrypt`.
2. **`matches(raw, stored)`** reads the `{id}` prefix and delegates to that algorithm's encoder. Old hashes keep working.
3. **`upgradeEncoding(stored)`** is `true` when the stored hash is not in the current default format. `DaoAuthenticationProvider` calls it after each successful login; if true *and* your `UserDetailsService` implements **`UserDetailsPasswordService`**, it re-hashes the just-received password and calls `updatePassword(...)`. Users migrate silently, one login at a time.

`PasswordEncodingTest` (a plain unit test, no Spring context) shows all of this:

```
PasswordEncoder enc = PasswordEncoderFactories.createDelegatingPasswordEncoder();
String h1 = enc.encode("s3cret");
String h2 = enc.encode("s3cret");
// ...
String argon = "{argon2@SpringSecurity_v5_8}" +
Argon2PasswordEncoder.defaultsForSpringSecurity_v5_8().encode("s3cret");
enc.matches("s3cret", argon);          // true: same encoder reads other algorithms
enc.upgradeEncoding("{noop}s3cret");   // true
```

Output:

```
encode #1 : {bcrypt}$2a$10$oExJt1cCgjfvb4DzBrmNo.VLE45g8zG8GLlEik43AL6a3Xbk8q20a
encode #2 : {bcrypt}$2a$10$oYZZ7zXC3LyJEl6nbQ9KbuQxmg1.oblxK/JPZ0/EufIiGHGFWX2ai
same input, different hash (random salt): true
matches(s3cret) = true, matches(S3cret) = false
argon2 row: {argon2@SpringSecurity_v5_8}$argon2id$v=19$m=16384,t=2,p=1$0...
matches(argon2 row) = true
upgradeEncoding({noop})  = true
upgradeEncoding(argon2)  = true
upgradeEncoding(bcrypt)  = false
```

A bcrypt value: `$2a$` variant, `10` cost (2^10 rounds), 22 chars of salt, 31 of hash — the salt is inside the string, no extra column. `upgradeEncoding(argon2)` is `true` only because this encoder's *default* is bcrypt: "upgrade" means "not the current default".

Choosing Argon2 as the default

To hash new passwords with Argon2 while accepting everything stored, build your own `DelegatingPasswordEncoder`:

```
Map<String, PasswordEncoder> known = Map.of(
        "argon2@SpringSecurity_v5_8", Argon2PasswordEncoder.defaultsForSpringSecurity_v5_8(),
        "bcrypt", new BCryptPasswordEncoder(),
        "noop", NoOpPasswordEncoder.getInstance());          // only to READ legacy rows
var enc = new DelegatingPasswordEncoder("argon2@SpringSecurity_v5_8", known);
```

Output:

```
argon2 default: {argon2@SpringSecurity_v5_8}$argon2id$v=19$m=16384,t=2,p=1$Y...
old bcrypt row still matches: true, needs upgrade: true
```

`m=16384,t=2,p=1` = 16 MiB memory, 2 passes, 1 lane (Spring's `v5_8` defaults). OWASP's Password Storage Cheat Sheet currently suggests somewhat more memory for Argon2id (e.g. 19 MiB, 2 passes) — use the `Argon2PasswordEncoder(saltLength, hashLength, parallelism, memory, iterations)` constructor. Changing parameters under the same id makes `upgradeEncoding` flag weaker stored hashes too. Measure on production hardware.

The work factor in numbers

```
bcrypt strength 10 -> $2a$10$...  ~59 ms per check
bcrypt strength 12 -> $2a$12$...  ~239 ms per check
```

Each +1 doubles the work (~4x for +2). Aim for "as slow as your login latency budget allows", often several hundred ms — but the cost hits *your* servers on every login, so slow hashing without rate limiting makes login an easy denial-of-service target (Chapter 11 rate limiting).

bcrypt's 72-byte limit

```
73-byte password -> IllegalArgumentException: password cannot be more than 72 bytes
```

bcrypt only reads the first 72 bytes; current Spring Security refuses longer input instead of silently truncating. Allow long passphrases → validate length at sign-up or choose Argon2.

Upgrading on login — proved

`dave` is stored as `{noop}dave-pass`; after one successful login his row holds a bcrypt hash:

```
System.out.println("before login: " + accounts.find("dave").passwordHash());
assertThat(mvc.get().uri("/me").with(httpBasic("dave", "dave-pass"))).hasStatusOk();
String after = accounts.find("dave").passwordHash();
assertThat(after).startsWith("{bcrypt}$2a$10$");
```

Output:

```
before login: {noop}dave-pass
after login : {bcrypt}$2a$10$6G6hiKY...
```

Common mistakes

- **Encrypting** passwords (AES) "so support can see them" — anyone with the key decrypts them all.
- Hand-made `sha256(password + "pepper")` — fast, so it cracks quickly.
- `NoOpPasswordEncoder` as the bean "for now" (deprecated for a reason).
- Hashes stored without the `{id}` prefix, then switching encoders: every old row breaks. `DelegatingPasswordEncoder.setDefaultPasswordEncoderForMatches(...)` tells Spring how to read unprefixed values.
- Too-short hash column: bcrypt is 60 chars plus `{bcrypt}`, Argon2 longer. Use `VARCHAR(255)`+.

In the interview

30-second answer: "Store only adaptive, salted hashes such as bcrypt or Argon2id, never encrypted or plain passwords. In Spring I use `DelegatingPasswordEncoder`: each hash carries an `{id}` prefix, new passwords use the current default, old formats still verify, and with `UserDetailsPasswordService` hashes upgrade transparently on the next successful login."

- *Why a salt?* → Equal passwords get different hashes; precomputed tables become useless. The salt is not secret.
- *bcrypt or Argon2?* → Both fine. Argon2id is memory-hard (GPU cracking costlier), OWASP's first choice; bcrypt is ubiquitous but has the 72-byte limit.
- *What is a pepper?* → An optional secret mixed into every hash and stored *outside* the database (in a vault). Helps only if the database leaks without the app secrets.

TL;DR

Hash, don't encrypt: Argon2id or bcrypt via `DelegatingPasswordEncoder` (`{id}hash`), `UserDetailsPasswordService` to upgrade on login, cost tuned to your hardware.

10.6 Authorizing requests: roles, authorities, 401 vs 403

What it is

`authorizeHttpRequests` is a list of **rules**, each pairing a request matcher with a requirement. For each request, `AuthorizationFilter` walks the list **top to bottom** and applies the **first rule that matches**. The rules you write most often:

Rule	Passes when
`permitAll()`	always (still goes through the other filters, e.g. CSRF)
`denyAll()`	never
`authenticated()`	caller is not anonymous
`hasAuthority("report:read")`	caller holds exactly that authority string
`hasAnyAuthority("a", "b")`	holds at least one
`hasRole("ADMIN")`	holds authority `ROLE_ADMIN` (the prefix is added for you)
`hasAnyRole("ADMIN", "OPS")`	holds `ROLE_ADMIN` or `ROLE_OPS`
`access(authorizationManager)`	your own `AuthorizationManager` decides, e.g. IP ranges or time of day

Matchers can take HTTP methods (`requestMatchers(HttpMethod.GET, "/reports/**")`) and use Spring MVC's `PathPattern` syntax (`*` one segment, `**` any number).

Roles vs authorities

Under the hood **there is only `GrantedAuthority`, a string**; a "role" is the convention that it starts with `ROLE_`.

	Role	Authority (permission)
Example	`ROLE_ADMIN`	`report:read` , `order:refund`
Granularity	coarse: *who the user is*	fine: *what the user may do*
Checked with	`hasRole("ADMIN")`	`hasAuthority("report:read")`
Typical source	user's group membership	role-to-permission mapping, OAuth2 scopes (permissions granted to a token, e.g. `read` ; `SCOPE_...` , Chapter 11)

Many teams check **authorities** in code and assign them to users *through* roles, so a role change is not a code change. Spring rejects both prefix mistakes:

```
hasRole("ROLE_ADMIN") -> ROLE_ADMIN should not start with ROLE_ since ROLE_ is automatically prepended when using hasRole. Consider using hasAuthority instead.
User.roles("ROLE_ADMIN") -> ROLE_ADMIN cannot start with ROLE_ (it is automatically added)
```

`User.withUsername(...).roles("ADMIN")` stores `ROLE_ADMIN` ; `.authorities("ROLE_ADMIN", "report:read")` stores the strings as given. The two setters **replace** each other (last call wins), so mixed lists use `authorities(...)` .

401 vs 403 — proved

Status	Name	Meaning	Client should
401	Unauthorized (really "unauthenticated")	"I don't know who you are"	authenticate, then retry
403	Forbidden	"I know who you are, and the answer is no"	not retry with the same identity

The matrix test calls five URLs as four callers:

```
assertThat(status("/admin/stats", null)).isEqualTo(401);      // who are you?
assertThat(status("/admin/stats", "carol")).isEqualTo(403);   // I know you, but no
assertThat(status("/reports/daily", "alice")).isEqualTo(200); // authority, not role
assertThat(status("/reports/daily", "bob")).isEqualTo(403);   // ADMIN role is not report:read
assertThat(status("/user/profile", "bob")).isEqualTo(200);    // role hierarchy ADMIN > USER
assertThat(status("/nowhere", "bob")).isEqualTo(403);         // denyAll catch-all
```

Output:

```
                                /public/hello  /user/profile  /admin/stats   /reports/daily /nowhere
anonymous                       200            401            401            401           401
alice (ROLE_USER, report:read)  200            200            403            200           403
carol (ROLE_USER)               200            200            403            403           403
bob (ROLE_ADMIN)                200            200            200            403           403
```

- **anonymous** gets 401 everywhere except the public URL, even `/nowhere`: a denied *anonymous* caller is always asked to authenticate first (§10.2).
- **alice** reaches `/reports/daily` via the `report:read` **authority**, though not an admin; **bob** (admin) gets **403** there — a role does not imply permissions never mapped to it.
- **bob** reaches `/user/profile` via the **role hierarchy** `ROLE_ADMIN > ROLE_USER` (applies to URL rules and method security).
- `/nowhere` has no controller yet is 403 for logged-in users: `anyRequest().denyAll()` closes everything unlisted, and security runs before MVC looks for a handler.

Why `denyAll()` last: with `anyRequest().authenticated()`, next month's new endpoint is open to *every logged-in user*; with `denyAll()` it stays closed until someone writes a rule. `authenticated()` is fine for internal apps; `denyAll()` is safer customer-facing.

Common mistakes

- **Rule order.** `requestMatchers("/**").authenticated()` first makes every later rule dead code. Most specific first.
- **Securing only the URL.** Can alice read `/orders/2`, which is carol's? That needs the *data* — method security or the query (IDOR, insecure direct object reference: reaching another user's record by changing an id; §10.7).
- Returning **404** for "exists but you may not see it" hides existence — decide deliberately; Spring gives 403.
- Relying on `permitAll()` to *skip* security — the request still passes CSRF and header filters. For static files use their own `permitAll()` chain; avoid `WebSecurityCustomizer.ignoring()`, which also drops security headers.

In the interview

> **30-second answer:** "401 means the server doesn't know who you are, so authenticate. 403 means it knows and refuses. In Spring, an `AccessDeniedException` for an anonymous user goes to the `AuthenticationEntryPoint` (401 or login redirect), for an authenticated user to the `AccessDeniedHandler` (403). Roles are authorities with a `ROLE_` prefix. I check fine-grained authorities and map them to roles."

- *`hasRole("ADMIN")` vs `hasAuthority("ADMIN")`?* → The first checks `ROLE_ADMIN`, the second the literal `ADMIN`.
- *Admins inheriting user permissions?* → A `RoleHierarchy` bean (`RoleHierarchyImpl.fromHierarchy("ROLE_ADMIN > ROLE_USER")`).

TL;DR

First matching rule wins: specific first, finish with `denyAll()` (or `authenticated()`). A role is a `ROLE_` authority; `hasRole` adds the prefix. 401 = unknown caller, 403 = known but not allowed.

10.7 Method security

What it is

URL rules protect *endpoints*. **Method security** (`@EnableMethodSecurity`) protects *business methods* whoever calls them — controller, listener, scheduled job — and can inspect **arguments and return value**, which

URL rules cannot.

Annotation	When it runs	Typical use
`@PreAuthorize("expr")`	before the call	role/authority checks, argument checks (`#owner == authentication.name`)
`@PostAuthorize("expr")`	after the call, sees `returnObject`	"load it, then check it belongs to the caller"
`@PreFilter("expr")`	before, filters a collection argument	rarely needed
`@PostFilter("expr")`	after, removes elements of the returned collection (`filterObject`)	small lists only
`@Secured("ROLE_ADMIN")`	before (enable with `securedEnabled = true`)	legacy, no SpEL
`@RolesAllowed("ADMIN")`	before (enable with `jsr250Enabled = true` ; JSR-250 is the Java standard that defined it)	Jakarta standard annotation

Expressions are **SpEL** (Spring Expression Language) with `authentication` , `principal` , `hasRole(...)` , `hasAuthority(...)` , parameters as `#name` , and `returnObject` .

```
@Service
public class OrderService {

    @PreAuthorize("#owner == authentication.name or hasRole('ADMIN')")
    public List<Order> ordersOf(String owner) { ... }

    @PostAuthorize("returnObject.owner() == authentication.name")
    public Order find(long id) { ... }

    @PostFilter("filterObject.owner() == authentication.name or hasRole('ADMIN')")
    public List<Order> all() { return new ArrayList<>(orders); }   // must be mutable

    @PreAuthorize("hasAuthority('order:refund')")
    public String refund(long id) { ... }
}
```

How it works

Method security is **proxy-based AOP** (Chapter 4): a proxy's interceptor evaluates the expression and throws `AccessDeniedException` if false. Same proxy rules as `@Transactional` : calls from inside the same class (`this.refund(1)` , **self-invocation** — proved in Chapter 4) skip the check, and `private` (and, with CGLIB, `final`) methods are never intercepted.

Proved

The tests call the service directly, with `@WithMockUser` supplying the security context:

```
@Test
@WithMockUser(username = "alice") // default role USER
void ownerCanReadOwnOrders() {
    orders.ordersOf("alice");                                   // allowed
    assertThatThrownBy(() -> orders.ordersOf("carol")).isInstanceOf(AccessDeniedException.class);
    assertThat(orders.all()).extracting(OrderService.Order::owner).containsOnly("alice");
    assertThatThrownBy(() -> orders.find(2)).isInstanceOf(AccessDeniedException.class);
    assertThatThrownBy(() -> orders.refund(1)).isInstanceOf(AccessDeniedException.class);
}
```

Output:

```
no SecurityContext, refund(1) -> AuthenticationCredentialsNotFoundException
alice ordersOf(alice)        -> [Order[id=1, owner=alice, cents=1999], Order[id=3, owner=alice, cents=250]]
alice ordersOf(carol)        -> AccessDeniedException
alice all() after @PostFilter -> [Order[id=1, owner=alice, cents=1999], Order[id=3, owner=alice, cents=250]]
alice find(2) (carol's)      -> AccessDeniedException (@PostAuthorize)
alice refund(1)              -> AccessDeniedException (needs order:refund)
bob(ADMIN) ordersOf(carol)   -> [Order[id=2, owner=carol, cents=500]]
support refund(1)            -> refunded 1
GET /orders/of/carol as alice -> HTTP 403
```

- A secured method called with **no** authentication (e.g. a background thread) fails with `AuthenticationCredentialsNotFoundException`.
- Over HTTP the service's `AccessDeniedException` travels back through the filters and becomes **403** via `ExceptionTranslationFilter`. A `@ControllerAdvice` `@ExceptionHandler(Exception.class)` must not swallow it into a 500.

Trade-offs

	URL rules	Method security
Protects	HTTP endpoints	any bean method, any caller
Can see	path, method, headers	arguments, return value, domain objects
Cost	cheap, before MVC	a proxy per bean. `@PostAuthorize` runs the method (and its SQL) before denying
Best for	coarse gates (`/admin/**`)	ownership and business rules

Use both: URLs as the outer fence, methods for "may *this* user touch *this* record". For large collections skip `@PostFilter` (loads everything, discards most) — filter in the query (`where owner = :currentUser`).

Common mistakes

- Forgetting `@EnableMethodSecurity` — annotations silently ignored.
- Self-invocation; annotating `private` methods.
- `@PostFilter` on an immutable `List.of(...)` — it removes elements, so needs a mutable collection.
- Complex SpEL strings — move logic into a bean: `@PreAuthorize("@orderGuard.canRead(#id, authentication)")`.

TL;DR

`@EnableMethodSecurity` + `@PreAuthorize` for business rules and ownership. Proxy-based: self-invocation and private methods are unprotected; `@PostAuthorize` runs the method (and its SQL) before denying. A denial becomes 403 over HTTP.

10.8 CSRF protection

What it is

Cross-site request forgery (CSRF) tricks a logged-in user's browser into sending a state-changing request to your site from another site; the browser attaches the session cookie automatically. The attack and browser-side defences (tokens, `SameSite` cookies) are in JS 14.11; here, what Spring does.

How Spring's CSRF protection works

1. `CsrfFilter` generates a random **CSRF token** per session, stored by default in the HTTP session (`HttpSessionCsrfTokenRepository`).
2. Server-rendered pages include it: Spring's login page, Thymeleaf forms and JSP tags add a hidden `_csrf` field automatically.

3. For **unsafe** methods (`POST` , `PUT` , `PATCH` , `DELETE`) the filter compares the `_csrf` parameter or `X-CSRF-TOKEN` / `X-XSRF-TOKEN` header with the stored token; missing or wrong → **403**.
4. **Safe** methods (`GET` , `HEAD` , `OPTIONS` , `TRACE`) are not checked — never change state in a `GET` .
5. Since Spring Security 6 the token is loaded **lazily** (no session touch when not needed) and the rendered value is **XOR-masked** with fresh randomness per request (defeats BREACH, which recovers secrets from compressed-response sizes): it looks different each time but validates the same.

Proved: on for the cookie app, off for the stateless API

```
// web chain (session cookie): CSRF on
mvc.post().uri("/web/notes").param("text", "hi").with(user("alice"))                              // no token
mvc.post().uri("/web/notes").param("text", "hi").with(user("alice")).with(csrf().useInvalidToken())
mvc.post().uri("/web/notes").param("text", "hi").with(user("alice")).with(csrf())                  // valid token
// api chain (Basic auth, STATELESS): CSRF disabled
mvc.post().uri("/api/notes").contentType(MediaType.TEXT_PLAIN).content("from curl").with(httpBasic("alice",
"alice-pass"))
```

Output:

```
login page hidden field: <input name="_csrf" type="hidden" value="<token>" />
POST /web/notes, logged in, no CSRF token  -> 403
POST /web/notes, logged in, wrong token    -> 403
POST /web/notes, logged in, valid token    -> 200
GET  /web/home,  no token needed (safe)     -> 200
POST /api/notes, Basic auth, no CSRF token -> 201
```

When may you disable it?

CSRF needs **ambient credentials** — ones the *browser* attaches on its own: cookies, browser-cached HTTP Basic, client certificates.

Your API authenticates with...	CSRF protection
session cookie (form login, OAuth2 login, BFF — Backend for Frontend, a server holding tokens for a browser app)	**keep it on**
`Authorization: Bearer <token>` added by JavaScript or a server, never cookies	can be disabled for that chain
Basic auth from scripts / other services only	can be disabled
both cookies *and* tokens on the same endpoints	keep it on

Single-page apps: `csrf.spa()` (Spring Security 7)

A cookie-session SPA still needs CSRF protection but can't read a hidden field. `http.csrf(c -> c.spa())` sets up the standard arrangement:

- token in a JavaScript-readable cookie `XSRF-TOKEN` (`HttpOnly=false`),
- the app echoes it in `X-XSRF-TOKEN` (Angular and axios do this automatically),
- a handler accepting both the raw cookie value and the masked form.

Before 7.0 this took `CookieCsrfTokenRepository.withHttpOnlyFalse()` plus a custom handler, as many tutorials still show.

Common mistakes

- `csrf.disable()` "because POST returned 403" in a session-cookie app — re-opens the attack. Send the token.
- Actions on `GET` (`GET /delete?id=5`) — unprotected, and link prefetchers can trigger them.
- Forgetting that `POST /logout` also needs the token (§10.10).

TL;DR

On by default for unsafe methods. Keep it wherever the browser sends credentials automatically; disable only for explicit-header chains; `csrf.spa()` for cookie-based SPAs.

10.9 CORS

What it is

CORS (Cross-Origin Resource Sharing) is how a *browser* lets JavaScript from origin A (scheme + host + port) read responses from origin B; the server opts in with `Access-Control-Allow-*` headers. For "non-simple" requests (e.g. `POST` with JSON or an `Authorization` header) the browser first sends a **preflight** `OPTIONS`. Browser rules: JS 14.2. CORS **protects nothing on the server** — it relaxes a browser restriction, and `curl` ignores it.

Why Spring Security must be involved

A preflight carries **no credentials** (browsers never send cookies or `Authorization` on it). If authentication ran first it would answer 401 and the browser would block the real request. `http.cors(...)` adds a `CorsFilter` *early* so preflights are answered before authentication.

```
@Bean
CorsConfigurationSource corsConfigurationSource() {
    CorsConfiguration api = new CorsConfiguration();
    api.setAllowedOrigins(List.of("https://app.example.com"));
    api.setAllowedMethods(List.of("GET", "POST"));
    api.setAllowedHeaders(List.of("Authorization", "Content-Type"));
    api.setMaxAge(3600L);                                  // browser may cache the preflight 1 hour
    UrlBasedCorsConfigurationSource source = new UrlBasedCorsConfigurationSource();
    source.registerCorsConfiguration("/api/**", api);
    return source;
}
// in the API chain:  .cors(Customizer.withDefaults())   -> uses this bean
```

Proved: a preflight, allowed and refused

```
mvc.options().uri("/api/notes")
        .header("Origin", origin)
        .header("Access-Control-Request-Method", "POST")
        .header("Access-Control-Request-Headers", "authorization,content-type")
```

Output:

```
preflight from https://app.example.com -> 200
  Access-Control-Allow-Origin: https://app.example.com
  Access-Control-Allow-Methods: GET,POST
  Access-Control-Allow-Headers: authorization, content-type
  Access-Control-Max-Age: 3600
preflight from https://evil.example   -> 403 body=Invalid CORS request
GET with Origin + Basic -> 200, Access-Control-Allow-Origin: https://app.example.com, Vary: [Origin, Access-Control-Request-Method, Access-Control-Request-Headers]
```

The allowed preflight gets **200 without credentials**; an unknown origin **403 "Invalid CORS request"**; the real request also gets `Access-Control-Allow-Origin`, with `Vary: Origin` telling caches the answer depends on the origin.

Trade-offs and choices

Option	Where	Use when
`CorsConfigurationSource` bean + `http.cors(...)`	security chain	the endpoints are secured (almost always)
`@CrossOrigin` on controllers / `WebMvcConfigurer.addCorsMappings`	Spring MVC (Chapter 5)	no Spring Security, or as the source that `http.cors()` falls back to when no `CorsConfigurationSource` bean exists
gateway / reverse proxy (see System Design Fundamentals)	outside the app	many services behind one edge

The general CORS mistakes (`"*"` with credentials, CORS only in MVC) are listed in Chapter 5, section 5.10.

TL;DR

`CorsConfigurationSource` + `http.cors(...)` so preflights are answered before authentication. Exact origins.

10.10 Sessions, the security context and logout

What it is

After form login the `Authentication` must survive to the next request: by default the `SecurityContext` is saved in the **HTTP session** (`HttpSessionSecurityContextRepository`), whose id the browser keeps in the `JSESSIONID` cookie. `sessionManagement(...)` controls this:

SessionCreationPolicy	Meaning
`IF_REQUIRED` (default)	create a session when needed (e.g. at login)
`ALWAYS`	always create one
`NEVER`	never create one, but use an existing session
`STATELESS`	never create or use one for the security context, so every request must authenticate itself (Basic, Bearer token)

Session fixation, concurrency and logout — proved

Session fixation: an attacker plants a known session id in the victim's browser *before* login and reuses it after. Defence: **change the session id at login** — Spring's default (`changeSessionId()` , via Servlet `HttpServletRequest.changeSessionId()`).

```
MockHttpSession session = new MockHttpSession();       // the anonymous visitor's session
String before = session.getId();
var login = mvc.post().uri("/login").session(session)
        .param("username", "alice").param("password", "alice-pass").with(csrf()).exchange();
MockHttpSession after = (MockHttpSession) login.getRequest().getSession(false);
// ... use the new session, then POST /logout with it
```

Output:

```
login  -> 302 /, session id changed: true (session fixation protection)
GET /web/home with that session -> 200
logout -> 302 /login?logout, session invalidated: true
API call -> session created? false, Set-Cookie: null
```

- Login changed the session id; the old one is worthless.

- `POST /logout` (with CSRF token) invalidated the session, cleared the context and redirected to `/login?logout`. `GET /logout` only shows a confirmation page — logout is a state change needing CSRF protection.
- The `STATELESS` API chain never created a session or sent `Set-Cookie`.

Other session features:

- **`maximumSessions(1)`** limits concurrent logins (the second expires the first, or `maxSessionsPreventsLogin(true)` rejects it); register an `HttpSessionEventPublisher` bean so Spring hears about timeouts.
- **Remember-me** (`rememberMe(...)`): a long-lived cookie across browser restarts; prefer the persistent-token variant.
- **Timeout**: `server.servlet.session.timeout=30m`; harden the cookie with `server.servlet.session.cookie.secure=true`, `http-only=true` (default), `same-site=lax` or `strict`.
- Several instances need a shared store: **Spring Session** keeps sessions in Redis or JDBC.

Stateless vs session: which one?

	Server session + cookie	Stateless (token per request)
Logout / revoke	immediate (invalidate session)	hard until the token expires (Chapter 11)
Scaling	needs sticky sessions (load balancer pins a user to one server) or Spring Session	any node can serve any request
CSRF	needed	not needed if the token is not in a cookie
Best for	browser apps, BFF	APIs called by other services, mobile apps

TL;DR

Form login stores the context in the session; the id changes at login; logout is `POST /logout` with a CSRF token; `STATELESS` chains never create sessions.

10.11 Security headers

What it is

`HeaderWriterFilter` adds response headers that switch on browser defences. From the test:

```
response headers on GET /web/home:
  Cache-Control: no-cache, no-store, max-age=0, must-revalidate
  Content-Length: 4
  Content-Security-Policy: default-src 'self'; frame-ancestors 'none'
  Content-Type: text/plain;charset=UTF-8
  Expires: 0
  Pragma: no-cache
  Referrer-Policy: strict-origin-when-cross-origin
  X-Content-Type-Options: nosniff
  X-Frame-Options: DENY
  X-XSS-Protection: 0
over HTTPS also: Strict-Transport-Security: max-age=31536000 ; includeSubDomains
```

Header	Default?	What it tells the browser
`Cache-Control` / `Pragma` / `Expires`	yes	don't cache authenticated pages (shared computers, proxies). Your own `Cache-Control` wins
`X-Content-Type-Options: nosniff`	yes	trust `Content-Type`, don't guess (stops some script-injection tricks)
`X-Frame-Options: DENY`	yes	don't render inside a frame (**clickjacking**: hiding your page in an invisible frame to steal clicks)
`Strict-Transport-Security` (HSTS — HTTP Strict Transport Security)	yes, **HTTPS responses only**	use HTTPS for this host for one year
`X-XSS-Protection: 0`	yes	*turn off* the old browser XSS filter, which itself caused vulnerabilities
`Content-Security-Policy`	**no**, you write it	which sources may load scripts, styles and frames. It is the strongest defence against **XSS**
`Referrer-Policy`	no (configured here)	how much of the URL to leak in `Referer`

We added CSP and Referrer-Policy in the web chain:

```
.headers(h -> h
    .contentSecurityPolicy(csp -> csp.policyDirectives("default-src 'self'; frame-ancestors 'none'"))
    .referrerPolicy(r -> r.policy(ReferrerPolicy.STRICT_ORIGIN_WHEN_CROSS_ORIGIN)))
```

XSS and CSP authoring: JS 14.10, JS 14.12. Roll out a new CSP with `.reportOnly()` first.

Common mistakes

- Disabling all headers (`headers(h -> h.disable())`) to fix one (e.g. an iframe) — change just that one: `frameOptions(f -> f.sameOrigin())`.
- Expecting HSTS on `http://localhost` — HTTPS only. Behind a TLS-terminating proxy set `server.forward-headers-strategy=framework` so the app knows the request was HTTPS.

TL;DR

Five protective headers on by default (HSTS only over HTTPS); add a CSP yourself; change individual headers rather than disabling all.

10.12 Testing security with `spring-security-test`

What it is

`spring-boot-starter-security-test` brings **spring-security-test**: helpers that put an identity or token into a test request — mock identities for rules, real credentials where login itself is under test:

Helper	Kind	What it does
`@WithMockUser(username, roles, authorities)`	annotation	puts a `UsernamePasswordAuthenticationToken` in the context for the test method, with no `UserDetailsService` involved. Default user `user`, role `USER`
`@WithUserDetails("alice")`	annotation	loads the real user from *your* `UserDetailsService`
`@WithAnonymousUser`	annotation	explicit anonymous caller
`with(user("alice").roles("USER"))`	request post-processor	like `@WithMockUser`, per request
`with(httpBasic("alice", "alice-pass"))`	request post-processor	adds a real `Authorization: Basic` header, so the full login path runs
`with(csrf())` / `csrf().useInvalidToken()`	request post-processor	adds a valid (or broken) CSRF token
`formLogin().user(..).password(..)`	request builder	a real `POST /login` including CSRF
`logout()`	request builder	a real `POST /logout`
`jwt()`, `opaqueToken()`, `oauth2Login()`, `oidcLogin()`	request post-processors	token and OAuth2 identities (Chapter 11)
`authenticated().withUsername(..)`, `unauthenticated()`, `withAuthorities(..)`	result matchers	assert on the security context after the request. `withAuthorities(String...)` is new in 7.0

`MockMvcTester` accepts these with `.with(...)`. `@SpringBootTest` + `@AutoConfigureMockMvc` applies the security chain automatically; with the `@WebMvcTest` slice add `@Import(SecurityConfig.class)` so *your* rules run, not Boot's defaults (Chapter 12).

What to test

1. **Each rule's boundaries**: anonymous, wrong role, right role (the 401/403 matrix is one test).
2. **The catch-all**: an unlisted URL is denied.
3. **CSRF**: unsafe requests fail without a token, succeed with one.
4. **Method rules** directly on the service with `@WithMockUser`, including ownership.
5. **At least one real login** (`httpBasic` / `formLogin`) to exercise the encoder and user lookup.

Common mistakes

- Testing only the happy path with `@WithMockUser(roles = "ADMIN")` — proves admins get in, not that others are kept out.
- `@WithMockUser` when code needs your custom principal class — use `@WithUserDetails` or a custom `@WithSecurityContext`.
- Forgetting `with(csrf())` and concluding "security blocks my POST".

TL;DR

`@WithMockUser` / `user()` for rules, `httpBasic()` / `formLogin()` for real logins, `csrf()` for unsafe methods, result matchers for "who is logged in". Test the denials.

10.13 Common mistakes (whole chapter)

Mistake	Symptom	Fix
Own `SecurityFilterChain` not picked up	generated password still printed	bean inside a scanned `@Configuration`
Catch-all chain ordered first	specific chain ignored	`securityMatcher` + `@Order`, specific first
`hasRole("ROLE_X")`	startup `IllegalArgumentException`	`hasRole("X")` or `hasAuthority("ROLE_X")`
`roles()` then `authorities()` on `User`	roles vanish	one call with the full list
`csrf.disable()` with session login	CSRF hole	send the token, or `csrf.spa()`
CORS only in MVC	preflight 401	`http.cors(...)` + `CorsConfigurationSource`
Plain/SHA hashed passwords	leak = cracked passwords	`DelegatingPasswordEncoder` with bcrypt/Argon2
Method security not enabled / self-invocation	annotations ignored	`@EnableMethodSecurity`, call through another bean
`anyRequest().permitAll()` at the end	new endpoints public	`denyAll()` or `authenticated()`
Security filter declared as `@Component`	runs twice, once outside the chain	`addFilterBefore` + disabled `FilterRegistrationBean`
Context lost in `@Async`	`AuthenticationCredentialsNotFoundException`	`DelegatingSecurityContextExecutor`
Actuator exposed with the app rules	`/actuator/env` public	its own chain or rules (Chapter 15)

10.14 In the interview

"Walk me through what happens when a request hits a Spring Security app." "The container calls `DelegatingFilterProxy`, which hands off to the `FilterChainProxy` bean; it picks the first `SecurityFilterChain` whose matcher fits. Filters run in order: the context is loaded (e.g. from the session), headers added, CSRF checked for unsafe methods, authentication filters try form/Basic/bearer, an anonymous token is set if nobody authenticated, and `AuthorizationFilter` checks the rules. `ExceptionTranslationFilter` turns a denial into 401/redirect for anonymous callers or 403 for known ones. If everything passes, the request reaches the `DispatcherServlet`."

Follow-ups:

- *Where is the user stored during and between requests?* → During: `SecurityContextHolder` (`ThreadLocal`). Between: the HTTP session (form login), or nowhere for stateless chains (client resends credentials/token).
- *Passwords?* → §10.5. *When is disabling CSRF safe?* → §10.8 (no ambient credentials, e.g. pure bearer-token APIs).
- *"Users only see their own orders"?* → Method security ownership expression, or better, scope the query by the current user; URL rules can't see ownership.
- *What changed in Spring Security 7?* → Lambda DSL only, old matchers and `authorizeRequests` removed, built-in MFA, `csrf.spa()`, Authorization Server merged in (§10.3).

Chapter 10 TL;DR

- **Architecture**: `DelegatingFilterProxy` → `FilterChainProxy` → first matching `SecurityFilterChain` → ordered filters → `AuthorizationFilter`. The user lives in `SecurityContextHolder`.
- **Configuration**: `SecurityFilterChain` beans, one lambda per feature. Spring Security 7 removed `and()`, `authorizeRequests` and the Ant/Mvc matchers. Use several chains with `securityMatcher` + `@Order`.
- **Authentication**: filter → `ProviderManager` → `DaoAuthenticationProvider` → `UserDetailsService` + `PasswordEncoder`. Browsers get a 302 to `/login`, APIs get a 401 challenge. Spring Security 7 adds `FACTOR_*` authorities for MFA.
- **Passwords**: adaptive salted hashes (bcrypt, Argon2id) via `DelegatingPasswordEncoder` (`{id}hash`), upgraded on login.
- **Authorization**: first matching rule wins. Roles are `ROLE_`-prefixed authorities. **401 = who are you, 403 = no**. End with `denyAll()`. Use method security for ownership.
- **Web defences**: CSRF on for cookie sessions (off only for header-token chains, `csrf.spa()` for SPAs). `http.cors()` so preflights pass. Session id changes at login. Default headers plus your own CSP.
- **Testing**: spring-security-test's `@WithMockUser`, `user()`, `httpBasic()`, `csrf()`, `formLogin()`, and test the denials.

Next: Chapter 11 — Tokens and OAuth2 replaces sessions and passwords with signed tokens and identity providers.